



Pack 04

Personal reset.

Get the basics running again: sleep, food, movement, people. Two rhythms, one for kids weeks and one for solo weeks.

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Two rhythms

Shared care means two different weeks: kids with you, and solo. Tools 14 and 16 plan both weeks. Tool 15 is for the nights on your own.

Start with Tool 13, the weekly reset. Every other pack points to it. [In the app: Admin →](#)

Reset the week before it starts.

Twenty minutes, once a week. Boring on the day, calming by the weekend. This is the one weekly sheet for every pack.

My reset night

For most people, the night before handover week starts.

01One priority per area

One line each. Leave blanks.

Kids

Money

Admin

Home

Me

02Coming up this week

Day

Event

[In the app: Week →](#)

03Reset checklist

Run it every week

Kids

☐ School bags ready

☐ Uniforms washed

☐ Medication packed

☐ Sports gear ready

☐ Handover times confirmed [Week →](#)

Money & admin

☐ Bills checked [Money →](#)

☐ Shared expenses logged [Records →](#)

☐ Deadlines reviewed

☐ School comms checked

☐ Documents filed

Me

☐ Meals roughly planned

☐ Groceries organised

☐ One support contact planned

☐ Movement planned

What would make this week calmer?

Structure reduces decision fatigue.

Shared care means two different weeks. Write down a few repeatable anchors for each, so the days don't have to be reinvented every morning. Your routine, not theirs. Theirs is Tool 06.

01

Morning

Task	Kids with me	Solo
Wake up		
Breakfast		
Shower, get ready		
School or work prep		
Leave the house		

02

Evening

Task	Kids with me	Solo
Dinner		
Screens down		
Kids prep		
Shower, wind down		
Sleep target		

03

Movement

Circle one or two you'll actually do

- Walk
- Run
- Gym
- Swim
- Yoga
- Stretch
- Cycle
- Team sport

Shade the kids days, then tick the days you'll move. A walk most days beats a perfect program you skip.

Mon☐

Tue☐

Wed☐

Thu☐

Fri☐

Sat☐

Sun☐

04

Weekly anchors

Circle three to keep

- Morning walk
- Weekly reset
- Meal prep
- Gym or run
- Calling a friend
- Early bedtime
- Reading
- Coffee out alone
- Phone-free hour
- Other

Which routines, if you kept them, would make life feel most functional?

The quiet feels loud at first.

Nights without the kids are one of the hardest shifts after separation. The point isn't to fill the silence. It's to have a plan ready, so the evening doesn't default to scrolling or drift.

01 Default plan

My low-pressure evening looks like

Dinner

Movement

Screen limit

Wind down

Sleep target

The night before they come back

Bags, food, one thing that makes their arrival nice.

02 Solo night checklist

Aim for most of these

- ☐ Eat a proper dinner.
- ☐ Tidy one small area.
- ☐ Move your body somehow.
- ☐ No messages to your ex after [time]. Draft it, don't send it.
- ☐ Decide your drink limit before 5pm.
- ☐ Mute or unfollow what keeps pulling you back.
- ☐ Do one calming thing.
- ☐ Sleep before midnight.

What usually makes solo nights harder, and what's one small thing that helps?

Someone will pick up.

Text

1800RESPECT

1800 737 732

Lifeline

13 11 14

MensLine Australia

1300 78 99 78

Family Relationship Advice Line

1800 050 321

Kids Helpline

1800 55 1800

In danger now: call 000

Five meals on repeat is fine.

Stress reduces executive function: choosing what's for dinner becomes one decision too many. Write down what you can make on autopilot, for kids nights and for just you, and a short shop list. That's the whole system.

01 Easy default meals

Kids nights	Key ingredients

Just me	Key ingredients

02 Emergency foods Keep stocked

☐ Frozen meals	☐ Pasta or rice
☐ Eggs	☐ Wraps
☐ Yoghurt	☐ Fruit
☐ Rotisserie chicken	☐ Soup
☐ Sandwich fillings	☐ Something the kids will always eat

03 Weekly shop Six categories

Lunches
Kids snacks
Breakfast
Dinner staples
Drinks
Household

Which foods, kept in the house, make the rest of the week easier?

You don't have to carry all of it.

After separation some people step in and some step back. This page is a quiet inventory of who's actually around, what they're good for, and where the gaps are.

01 Practical support

Person	Can help with

02 Emotional support

Person	Why they help

03 Professional support

Names and numbers in one place

Role	Name	Number
GP		
Therapist or counsellor		
EAP at work (free, confidential counselling)		
Family Relationship Centre		
Lawyer		
Mediator		
Accountant		
Financial adviser		
Other		

Someone will pick up.

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Who do you feel calmer around afterwards, and are you letting them help?

Notice what is slowly improving.

Progress is mostly invisible from the inside. Score each area once a week for six weeks, then read across the rows. Roughly is fine.

01

Six-week check-in

Score 1 to 5 · 1 rough, 5 steady

	Week 1 -- / --	Week 2 -- / --	Week 3 -- / --	Week 4 -- / --	Week 5 -- / --	Week 6 -- / --
Sleep						
Energy						
Money						
Parenting rhythm						
Home stability						
Emotional capacity						
Physical health						
Social connection						

Do it at the end of your Tool 13 reset.

What became slightly easier?

What would help life feel five percent steadier next week?

Closing note

You do not need to reinvent your life.
The first goal is the lights back on.

Sleep, food, one person, some movement. When those are running, the harder decisions get easier to make.